MS EXCEL · UNIT 6

Column Width & Row Height

AutoFit, row height, default width, hide / unhide, insert / delete

6	6	5	4
Topics	Practices	Width methods	Height methods

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Why adjust column width?

6.1 · Theory

By default every column is 8.43 characters wide and every row is 15 pt tall. That causes problems.

BEFORE — DEFAULT WIDTHS

Student Nam…	Score	Grade
Ahmed Ali Kha…	1450	85.00%
Sara Begum K…	1820	92.00%
Bilal Hassan R…	1230	78.00%

Text is cut off

AFTER — AUTOFIT APPLIED

Student Name	Score	Grade %
Ahmed Ali Khan	1,450	85.00%
Sara Begum Khan	1,820	92.00%
Bilal Hassan Raza	1,230	78.00%

Each column fits its content

AUTOFIT TIP

Select all (Ctrl+A) → double-click any column border — ALL columns AutoFit at once.

Practice 6.1: Set up the sheet

Practice · 1 of 6

GOAL

Type a small table, then find where the columns are too narrow.

1. Open a new workbook. In `A1` to `E1` type: `Name`, `Score`, `Grade %`, `Amount`, `Status`.
2. Type the 5 students in rows 2–6 (see the table). In `A7` type `Total`.
3. Click `A2`. Look at the Formula Bar. Do not change any widths yet.

Name	Score	Grade %	Amount	Status
Ahmed Ali Khan	1450	0.85	5000	Pass
Sara Begum Khan	1820	0.92	7500	Pass
Bilal Hassan Raza	1230	0.78	4200	Pass
Zara Mir	980	0.62	3100	Fail
Omar Butt	1640	0.88	6300	Pass

Look: long names are cut off — but the Formula Bar shows the full name. Only the display is wrong.

Changing column width — 5 methods

6.2 · Theory

Method	How to do it	Best for
Drag the border	Hover between two column letters → cursor becomes ↔ → drag	Quick visual adjustment
AutoFit (double-click)	Double-click the border between two column letters	Instant fit to content
AutoFit all columns	Ctrl+A → double-click any column border	Tidying a whole sheet — fastest
Exact width (Ribbon)	Home → Cells → Format → Column Width → type a number → OK	A precise size
Exact width (right-click)	Right-click the column letter → Column Width → type a number → OK	Quick exact sizing

AUTOFIT VIA RIBBON

Select the column → Home → Cells → Format → AutoFit Column Width. Use it when you cannot double-click the border.

Practice 6.2: AutoFit and exact width

Practice · 2 of 6

GOAL

Fix every column with AutoFit, then set column A to a precise width.

1. Press `Ctrl+A` to select the whole sheet.
2. Point at a border between two column letters.
3. When you see ↔, double-click.
4. Right-click the `A` header → `Column Width`.
5. Type `22` → OK.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Every column fits its content
- Column A is exactly 22 wide
- Nothing is cut off

Changing row height — 4 methods

6.3 · Theory

Row height is measured in points (pt). The default is 15 pt.

Method	How to do it	Notes
Drag the border	Hover over the line between two row numbers until the cursor becomes ↕ → drag	Visual — no exact value
Exact height	Right-click the row number → Row Height → type a number → OK	Units are points (pt)
AutoFit row height	Double-click the border between two row numbers	Fixes Wrap Text rows that did not expand
AutoFit via Ribbon	Select the row → Home → Cells → Format → AutoFit Row Height	When the border is hard to target

TIP

Header rows look best at 22–24 pt. Title rows at 28–32 pt. Match the row height to the font size.

Practice 6.3: Row heights

Practice · 3 of 6

GOAL

Give the header and data rows professional heights.

1. Right-click row number `1` → **`Row Height`**.
2. Type `22` → OK.
3. Select rows `2` to `6`.
4. Right-click → **`Row Height`**.
5. Type `18` → OK.

SET THESE HEIGHTS

Header	→ 22
Data rows	→ 18

- The header row is taller
- Compare with a classmate

Default width for the whole sheet

6.4 · Theory

Default column width

Every column starts at the same width. To change ALL columns at once:

Home → Cells → Format → Default Width → type a number → OK

Student Name	`8.43 (default)`
Student Name	`12 (wider)`
Student Name	`20 (very wide)`

Default row height

Row heights adjust to the font size automatically. There is no single Default Height option.

Instead: change the font size, or use AutoFit Row Height after turning on Wrap Text.

GOOD TO KNOW

Default Width does not resize columns you already adjusted — only untouched ones. Set it at the start of a project.

Practice 6.4: Default width and row AutoFit

Practice · 4 of 6

GOAL

Change the default column width, then fix all row heights in one step.

1. Home → Format → **Default Width**.
2. Type **11** → OK.
3. Check: column A (22) did not change.
4. Select rows **2** to **6**.
5. Right-click → **AutoFit Row Height**.
6. Press **Ctrl+End**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Default width is now 11
- Column A is still 22
- Data rows fit their content
- The Name Box shows the last used cell

Hiding and unhiding

6.5 · Theory

Hide a column

Select the column → right-click → Hide. Or: Home → Format → Hide & Unhide → Hide Columns.

Unhide a column

Select the columns on BOTH sides (for hidden D, select C and E) → right-click → Unhide.

Hide a row

Select the row → right-click → Hide. Works the same as a column — use the row numbers.

Unhide a row

Select the rows on BOTH sides → right-click → Unhide. Or: Ctrl+A → right-click a header → Unhide.

Hide several

Ctrl+click several column or row headers → right-click → Hide.

Spot a hidden column

The letters skip: A, B, E means C and D are hidden. They still calculate — they just do not display or print.

Hidden columns still exist — their data is used in formulas. A missing letter in the headers means a column is hidden.

Practice 6.5: Hide and unhide

Practice · 5 of 6

GOAL

Hide the Amount column, check the data is safe, then unhide it.

1. Click the column **D** header (Amount).
2. Right-click → **Hide**.
3. Type **D2** in the Name Box → Enter.
4. Select columns **C** to **E**.
5. Right-click → **Unhide**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- The letters jump from C to E
- D2 still holds its data
- Column D is back

Inserting and deleting rows & columns

6.6 · Theory

INSERTING

Insert a row

Right-click the row number → Insert. Rows are pushed DOWN.

Insert a column

Right-click the column letter → Insert. Columns are pushed RIGHT.

Insert several

Select as many rows or columns as you want to add → right-click → Insert.

DELETING

Delete a row

Right-click the row number → Delete. The row AND its data go. Rows shift UP.

Delete a column

Right-click the column letter → Delete. Columns shift LEFT.

Delete vs Clear

Delete removes the row entirely. Clear (Delete key) only empties the cells.

WARNING

Deleting is permanent unless you press Ctrl+Z at once. Hiding keeps the data — deleting does not.

Practice 6.6: Insert and delete

Practice · 6 of 6

GOAL

Insert a row and a column, then delete them to restore the sheet.

1. Right-click row number `2` → `Insert`.
2. Type `Class:` in A2 and `8-B` in B2.
3. Right-click column `A` → `Insert`.
4. Right-click the new column `A` → `Delete`.
5. Right-click row number `2` → `Delete`.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- A blank row pushes Ahmed down
- A new blank column A appears
- Ahmed Ali is back in row 2
- Ctrl+Z fixes any mistake

Unit 6 — Key takeaways

6.1	The default width (8.43 characters) cuts text off — AutoFit sizes each column to its content.
6.2	Five ways to set column width: drag, double-click, Ctrl+A then double-click, right-click, Ribbon.
6.3	Row height is in points (default 15). Headers 22 pt, titles 28 pt. AutoFit fixes Wrap Text rows.
6.4	Default Width changes all untouched columns at once — set it before entering data.
6.5	Hidden columns still exist and still calculate. Unhide by selecting both neighbours.
6.6	Insert shifts rows down and columns right. Delete removes the data. Delete is not Clear.

Your completed table

Result

Built step by step in Practices 6.1 to 6.6 — every Unit 5 skill in one sheet.

Name	Score	Grade %	Amount	Status
Ahmed Ali Khan	1450	0.85	5000	Pass
Sara Begum Khan	1820	0.92	7500	Pass
Bilal Hassan Raza	1230	0.78	4200	Pass
Zara Mir	980	0.62	3100	Fail
Omar Butt	1640	0.88	6300	Pass
Total				

CHECK YOUR WORK

Columns fit their content • header row 22 pt, data rows 18 pt • Amount column back after Unhide • extra row and column deleted.